

Travel & Expense Policy

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Department	Finance
Approved By	Chief Financial Officer
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1. Purpose

This policy sets out how business travel is approved, booked and paid for, and how employees claim expenses incurred during travel.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees travelling on Beacon business within India or abroad. Detailed limits for hotels and meals are in BT-FIN-004. General claims are covered in BT-FIN-002. Corporate card use is in BT-FIN-003.

3. Employee Levels

For the purpose of travel limits, employees are grouped as follows.

Level	Designations
Level A	Associates, Engineers, Analysts, Executives
Level B	Senior Engineers, Leads, Managers
Level C	Directors and above

4. Approval Limits

The same limits apply to travel and other business expenses.

Total Cost of Trip or Expense	Approval Required
Up to ₹25,000	Reporting Manager
Above ₹25,000 and up to ₹1,00,000	Department Head
Above ₹1,00,000	Chief Financial Officer

5. Main Rules

5.1 Booking Travel

- All flights, trains and hotels must be booked through the Beacon Travel Desk (travel@beacon-tech.example) after the manager's approval on the Beacon Finance Portal.

- Bookings should be made at least 7 days in advance for domestic travel and 14 days in advance for international travel, to get better fares.
- The lowest logical fare must be chosen.

5.2 Mode and Class of Travel

Mode	Eligible Class
Domestic flights	Economy
International flights	Economy. For continuous flights longer than 8 hours, Premium Economy with Department Head approval. Business class only with CEO approval.
Train	AC 2-Tier or Executive Chair Car
Bus	AC sleeper or AC semi-sleeper
Local travel	App-based cab, auto or metro, with receipts
Own vehicle	₹8 per km for car and ₹3 per km for two-wheeler, with a travel log

5.3 Hotel and Meals

Hotel and meal limits are in BT-FIN-004. Hotel stays must be booked through the Travel Desk.

5.4 Travel Advance

- Employees may request an advance of up to 75% of the estimated trip cost on the Finance Portal.
- The advance must be settled within 10 working days of returning. Unsettled advances are recovered from salary.

5.5 Submitting Travel Expenses

- Travel expense reports must be submitted on the Finance Portal within 10 working days of returning from the trip, with original bills or e-tickets.
- Claims are approved as per the approval limits above and paid within 10 working days of final approval.

5.6 International Travel

- International meals are limited to USD 50 per day.
- Hotel limits are USD 150 per night for Levels A and B, and USD 220 for Level C.
- Visa fees and the company-arranged travel insurance are paid by Beacon.
- Employees must carry the company laptop as hand luggage and use the VPN on hotel Wi-Fi (BT-IT-002 and BT-IT-003). If travelling abroad and needing VPN access, approval must be taken in advance.

5.7 Weekend Travel and Personal Extension

- Approved travel on a weekend or public holiday counts as work for comp-off (see BT-HR-002).
- If an employee extends a business trip for personal reasons, the extra days are not paid by Beacon and annual leave must be applied for (BT-HR-001).

5.8 Expenses Not Reimbursed

Alcohol, minibar items, personal entertainment, traffic fines, laundry for trips shorter than 5 nights, and family members' travel are not reimbursed.

6. Exceptions

- The CFO may approve exceptions to class of travel or limits in emergencies, such as a client escalation or a medical situation. Written approval is required.
- Expenses incurred without prior approval may be reimbursed if the manager and Department Head confirm they were necessary.

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